



second quarter earnings on the metaverse. This was done using GMetri, a platform on which you can create your metaverse within minutes without any coding at all. The metaverse content included over an hour of results summary and commentary by the top management, as well as several slides, graphics, transcripts, and quotes that analysts could view and download. It could be accessed using any device, even smartphones and laptops, without the need for any VR or augmented reality (AR) gear.

GMetriXR is a no-code toolkit to create, manage, and track your own metaverse. It is replete with a large number of ready-to-go media assets and gamified features, which you can put together to create an immersive environment. The company is aiming to democratise the metaverse, so anyone can create their own space without any prior experience or coding skills.

Democratisation seems to be a prominent theme today. Shriram Group's Novac Technologies was speaking on similar lines when they showcased their tools at the Gulf Information Technology Exhibition (Gitex) in Dubai this October. Novac believes that Indian companies are more comfortable having their own metaverse domain rather than having to buy land in decentralised ones like Decentraland or The Sandbox, and they help them with this requirement. They have over 50 clients in the manufacturing space. For most, they have helped create digital twins replicating the physical models in their factories for training across departments, including operations, human resources, and administration. They have also developed several immersive soft skills training courses in association



Inside Walmart Land (Courtesy: Roblox)

with a European company called Bodyswaps.

In a media report, Pradeep B., Associate Vice President, Novac, remarked that financial services companies are also now interested in tapping into the potential of the metaverse for branding and product development. "For instance, banks are likely to have digital avatars of real bank executives alongside existing AI-powered chatbots to help customers during and after office hours," he said.

On the same lines of democratisation, digital entertainment and technology company JetSynthesis announced in September that it has acquired a major stake in Metaphy Labs to offer metaverse-as-a-service (MAAS) to brands desirous of building their own metaverses, with immersive user experiences and meta-commerce as well. JetSynthesis is backed by famous investors like Kris Gopalakrishnan, Adar Poonawalla, and Sachin Tendulkar.

NVIDIA has also fashioned a neat MAAS offering, especially suited for manufacturing industries. NVIDIA CEO Jensen Huang explained in a recent media report that, "When you say 'metaverse,' they imagine putting on VR headsets, but it's obviously not just that. You can do that, but you can also enjoy it in 2D. One of my favourite ways of enjoying the metaverse is a whole bunch of robots in the

metaverse doing work and communicating with robots that are outside in the physical world. The physical world and the metaverse can be connected in a lot of different ways. It doesn't just have to be humans. It can be machine to machine."

As part of Omniverse Cloud—a suite of cloud services for metaverse applications—NVIDIA is

rolling out simulations for developing, testing, and managing artificial intelligence based robots and autonomous vehicles. Omniverse's 3D collaborative tools run on NVIDIA's well-known chips and hardware, including NVIDIA OVX—a computing system specifically designed to power large-scale digital twin simulations, which replicate real-world spaces in a metaverse environment.

Banks too have started banking on meta

After the pandemic, which proved that online services are indispensable, banks and other financial institutions are looking at the metaverse as one more way to stay in touch with customers. The first bank to enter the metaverse was perhaps JP Morgan, which opened a lounge called Onyx on Decentraland in February this year to engage with next-gen users. Subsequently, HSBC also opened a similar lounge on The Sandbox.

In July this year, Union Bank of India launched its metaverse virtual lounge, the Uni-verse, in association with Tech Mahindra. Users can roam around the lounge and get information about bank deposits, loans, government welfare schemes, and so on. The bank plans to use the lounge to publicise its products, but does not intend to enable transactions on it in the near future.

Recently, Kiya.ai, a Mumbai